Holiday Stays at Villa Koukouvayia Farms:
Answers to some FAQs



Finding a Best Fit for Your Holiday Home

Villa Koukouvayia Farms will serve as the perfect holiday home for yourself, your friends & your family during your stay in Western Crete. With three separate residential homes, the estate offers privacy and flexibility for a wide variety of travelers: from couples to young families to groups of friends or families up to 28. Whether you've come to for the island's beaches & mountains, its history, food & wines, or simply to relax among a landscape of green olives & blue sky with those you love, Villa Koukouvayia is ideally designed, built & located to put all of those in your hand.

So, as you consider your stay on the island, let's talk about how Villa Koukouvayia Farms can serve as the home base and the heart of a great holiday.

Lodging at Villa Koukouvayia Farms

Villa Koukouvayia Farms is a unique property, with four unique residential choices: the Main House, Guest House, Garden Suite and (by combining all three) the entire Estate itself. By design, these are not banks of identical hotel rooms, but each is a private home for those seeking such ambience and they allow you to customize your lodging whether you're a young couple, small family, or larger friendship & family groups seeking a warm place to gather and share. And while her lodging capacities are unique, their flexibility is the farm's greatest asset, with strategically placed cabinet bedding easily configured to meet multiple bedding needs.

To see how your group's lodging needs can be comfortably met, review the table below. The numbers describe each of the residence's sleeping capacities as well as the entire estate's if rented as a whole. They include both typical numbers we host & the maximum possible chosen by some groups.

Villa Koukouvayia Lodging Capacities	VKF Estate	Main House	Guest House	Garden Suite
Private Bedrooms:	8	3	2	3
Single Beds:	14	1	2	11
Couple's Bedding:	6	2	1	3
Full Baths:	5	2	1	2
Half-Baths:	2	1	1	0
Typical Sleeping Capacity:	15—20	5	4	6—11
Additional Sleep Areas:	6	3	2	1
Additional Single Bedding Available:	6	4	2	0
Additional Couple's Bedding Available:	1	0	0	1
Additional Sleeping Capacity:	8	4	2	2
Max Capacity Recommended:	24	7	4	13
Max Capacity Allowed:	28	9	6	13

Note: For programs needing capacities beyond Villa Koukouvayia, or with a desire to house facilitators nearby vs. onsite, we have relationships with several nearby homes—one of which is a charming private cottage only a few steps through the olive groves from VKF's estate. We can often secure these homes at discounted rates and easily integrate the cost within your invoice.

Occupancies Included & Available

To fairly price a variety of group sizes, we set base rates to allow inexpensive stays for smaller groups, then use a supplement (€13/extra-guest/night) to let larger groups match costs to their lodging needs & value. The next table specifies guests included in the rates that follow, & those allowed at extra charge.

Guest Capacities	VKF Estate	Main House	Guest House	Garden Suite
Guests Included in Base Rate:	16	6	4	6
Extra Guests Allowed w/Supplement:	12	3	2	7

Note: Infants under 2 years at the time of arrival are not counted in these limits or pricing.

Calculating Costs

For all whom we host, our goal is to be fair & transparent in our charges, and to avoid surprises once guests decide to stay with us. For instance, Greek taxes paid on your behalf are progressive, confusing and high, including both a daily Climate Resilience Tax & a tax on the value of the rental as high as 45%(!) To keep your costs low we cap the rental tax @ the VAT rate of 24%; and to ensure you don't worry about *any* of it, we include every tax in the worksheets below and in any offer we send you.

Simply put, we want you to know all costs before deciding to stay with us.

(And if comparing Villa Koukouvayia's to others', make sure they too are fully inclusive!)

Lodging Rates

The table below lists Villa Koukouvayia's lodging rates by season for each residential option. Each rate, multiplied by the nights you will stay, includes all lodging amenities from the afternoon of your arrival until the morning of your departure and all taxes.

As you can imagine, the majority of labor that creates your comfortable stay occurs in the fixed costs of preparing the property for your arrival. So that we can spread those expenses across lower rates and still welcome shorter stays, we do have a minimum charge, but it can be easily calculated based on your nominal reservation rate x5 for the Guest House and x7 for the other three properties. Should you prefer a shorter stay, examples at typical occupancy are shown in the table.

Season/ Month	Daily Rates				Minimum Reservation			
	Main House (w/6 guests)	Guest House (w/4 guests)	Garden Suite (w/6 guests)	Entire Estate (w/16 guests)	Main House (w/6 guests)	Guest House (w/4 guests)	Garden Suite (w/6 guests)	Entire Estate (w/16 guests)
Jan & Feb	€ 116	€ 64	€ 60	€ 295	€ 785	€ 312	€ 395	€ 2,044
Mar & Dec	€ 147	€ 76	€ 72	€ 357	€ 1,002	€ 374	€ 481	€ 2,478
Apr & Nov	€ 170	€ 89	€ 89	€ 399	€ 1,100	€ 411	€ 536	€ 2,706
May & Oct	€ 207	€ 113	€ 114	€ 499	€ 1,360	€ 535	€ 709	€ 3,400
Jun & Sep	€ 263	€ 144	€ 145	€ 629	€ 1,751	€ 690	€ 926	€ 4,312
Jul & Aug	€ 337	€ 182	€ 182	€ 790	€ 2,272	€ 876	€ 1,187	€ 5,440

Note1: Rates include all taxes & fees, but as noted above, are priced to protect groups not bringing the maximum number of guests from being overcharged. For larger groups, add €13/night for each extra guest.

Note2: To ensure your arrival's timing doesn't affect costs, reservations bridging multiple rate-seasons are calculated by each day within a seasonal rate, and the two subtotals are simply added.

Supplemental & Concierge Services

When not welcoming holiday travelers to Western Crete, we organize retreats that capitalize on the historic, culinary, topographic & recreational landscapes on the island, and we can do the same for you, supercharging your Cretan experience and bearing the stress of such arrangements. Trustworthy car rentals? Great vegetarian tavernas near Elafonisi? Unknown beaches? Best safe spots for 12-year olds to jump in the sea? Traversing Samaria Gorge without the crowds? We can provide you the same local knowledge (and savings) we apply to our programs, saving you the angst of ensuring your family's great time in a new & foreign place, so you can enjoy the same. Transportation, food & activity services are available either holistically or a la carte, and because we know the island, we can integrate each into the holiday you want. If interested, just let us know after booking, and we'll schedule a chat!

Other Cost Considerations

The following details may not affect costs but bear on how we coordinate financial aspects of your stay.

Extended-Stay Discounts

We provide season-based discounts for programs lodging guests longer than two weeks.

Season/Month	14 Days	28 Days	56 Days
January & February	10%	15%	25%
March & December	7%	10%	20%
April & November	5%	7%	15%
May & October	3%	5%	10%
June & September	0%	3%	7%
July & August	0%	3%	5%

Note1: These discounts apply to base reservation costs before taxes or extra occupancy charges.

Note2: As with rates, discounts across "seasons," are calculated per-day, then subtotaled to ensure full deduction.

Reserving Your Time & Payment Plans

Smaller reservations are typically booked via full payment of the reservation's cost & security deposit. Larger reservations over €3,000 can qualify for 2, 3 or 4 payments depending on the reservation's value and the length of time between booking and your arrival. When you submit your inquiry, we will automatically calculate those options & share the details in our offer.

Damage/Security Deposits

While not affecting your net expense, once you decide to book with us, your initial payment will include a minimum security-deposit to hold that time against other requests and then later to serve as a damage-deposit during your stay. We set these amounts low to reflect typical guests but will increase them for groups that present a higher likelihood of damage, such as those bringing pets, youth groups, etc.

Of course, assuming no major issues, deposits are always returned via bank transfer at departure.

Security/Reservation Deposits	Estate	Youth Groups
Security/Damage Deposits:	€1,000	€1,000
Pet Damage Deposit Supplement (Max 2):	€200/pet	

Note: We never confuse 'damage' with 'use.' Yes, we assume you will ensure your group respects Villa Koukouvayia, but we also expect you to use the facility and enjoy yourself during your stay. And we've been hosting groups long enough to understand that any gathering of happy people—particularly if happy children are part of the mix—will drop a glass or two. And while we don't like broken glass, we do like it when you're happy!

Currency

As our location demands, we charge in Euros. We accept USD if needed, and unlike banks, card-processors & 3rd-party platforms, we use the simple IMF exchange rate without surcharges or fees.

Cancellation Policy

We always work to rebook cancelled stays, refund all payments to the degree we have rebooked that time, and never charge a fee for this service. While this is often easily done, especially with an early warning of your need to cancel, it cannot be guaranteed.

Payment Methods

We encourage direct (IBAN or, in the USA, intrabank) transfers that are easy, safe and free. We *can* accept payments through credit cards, but unlike larger third-party sites, we do not hide the inevitable payment-processing fees across all our rates and in doing so charge all customers the 3.5% to 5% fee from which only a few customers benefit. Card options and the processing details will be itemized in any offer we send, so you can choose a payment method that works best for you.

Individual Bargaining vs. Standard Price

Although we understand a guest's desire either to get a better deal than others or simply meet a limited budget, we feel honor-bound in our interactions with *each* guest to consider *all* guests. So we simply don't make individual deals that favor a guest who requests special prices, because that effectively overcharge guests who quietly trust us to publish prices that reflect our honest rates. Instead, we focus on setting sincerely low rates that allow us to sustain the home and hospitality we offer. And for anyone wondering about our value, we recommend they look at comparable lodgings and read what other customers have said about their experience with us. We post every review written by guests, and we are proud of the consistency with which they agree about the value of staying with us.

Some Final FAQs

Check-In & Check-Out Times

Check-In & Check-Out Times: As always, our goal is to make your stay *and* your arrival and departure stress-free. While we guarantee arrival check-ins of 16:00 & departure check-outs of 10:00, we can often advance or extend those. There are times, however, when guests depart/arrive close to you, and we must follow those times strictly, so be prepared. Of course, when your flights are at odds with such check-in & check-out times, we'll always offer early luggage-drop or late luggage-hold so you can do something enjoyable while waiting—either for us to ready your home, or the airline to ready your flight.

Smoking

Smoking: We are set among groves of olive trees, all beautiful, but all susceptible to tragic fires. Smoking is therefore severely restricted, especially during the 3 fire seasons. Wet ashtrays always, always outside, only on verandas, and only on windless days.

Any Other Questions?

Your holidays, like you, should be special. So if you have any questions, just let us know. Share your goals and hopes for your time on Crete, and we make sure the home you choose is perfect!

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